

RENATA BLAZHKO

Technical Product Manager — Payments

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PROFILE

Product & Payments Analyst with 7+ years in high-risk fintech and iGaming-adjacent analytics. Currently own end-to-end API-based PSP integrations (20+/month, including local payment methods such as e-wallets and transfers) across 25+ countries for a mobile B2C platform with millions of active users, and led a fraud-process redesign that lifted authorization rate (AR) and cut incident-response time by up to 70%. Runs growth experiments end-to-end — A/B tests on checkout and bonus flows delivered +10% conversion/AR and -15% processing costs. AI-native by habit, not just by résumé line: builds and ships real products solo using Claude Code, Cursor, and multi-LLM stacks — including a self-built wellbeing bot with 1,000+ users. Comfortable owning ambiguous, operational problems without waiting on long approval chains.

CORE SKILLS

Payments & Fraud: API-based PSP integrations (20+/month, 25+ countries incl. local payment methods — e-wallets, transfers), AR (authorization rate) optimization, fraud process design & SLA management, VIP/mass traffic segmentation, chargeback & dispute data coordination, PSP commission review

Analytics & Experimentation: SQL (advanced), Python (pandas, scikit-learn), R, A/B & hypothesis testing, cohort/retention/churn analysis, risk segmentation

BI & Tooling: Tableau, Superset, Power BI (Metabase-equivalent stack), dashboarding for funnels & payment monitoring, ETL pipelines & data warehousing

AI-Native: Claude Code, Cursor, GitHub Copilot / VS Code AI — builds and ships products solo without a traditional dev team

Product & Leadership: Team leadership (5+ analysts), cross-functional collaboration, KPI development, executive reporting, customer journey mapping

EXPERIENCE

Team Lead, Data & Business Analysis | Dec 2024 – Present

Global online services provider, 25+ countries, millions of monthly transactions. Focus on financial products, payments, and compliance.

- **Payments:** Own end-to-end API-based payment integrations across PSPs for a mobile B2C platform with millions of active users, spanning 25+ countries — 20+ integrations shipped per month, including local payment methods (e-wallets, transfers) alongside card rails.
- **Fraud & AR:** Redesigned the fraud-response workflow from the ground up: split VIP vs. mass traffic into two dedicated monitoring dashboards, each with its own SLA — lifted authorization rate (AR) and cut fraud reaction time by 70% on VIP traffic and 33% on mass traffic within one quarter, tracking AR by payment method and country.
- **Disputes:** Coordinate chargeback/dispute data collection across the analytics team, compiling evidence packages for compliance and country management within SLA.
- **Commissions:** Review and validate PSP commission terms as part of ongoing payments monitoring.
- **Experiments:** Designed and ran A/B tests on checkout flows and bonus/incentive mechanics, measuring impact on conversion, AR, and fraud rate — +10% conversion, -15% processing costs.
- **Dashboards:** Built SQL/Python/Tableau dashboards for product and payment funnels, enabling faster, self-serve decision-making.
- **Leadership:** Own product analytics (DAU/WAU/MAU, conversion, retention, churn, ROI) and lead a team of product, data, and business analysts; partner directly with product, marketing, and IT on roadmap decisions.

Manager / Senior Consultant, IT Consulting | Oct 2023 – Dec 2024

Global "Big Four" professional services firm — consulting, audit, and strategy.

- Led a team of 5 business analysts delivering analytics and strategy projects for clients including Tinkoff, Ozon, X5, and Sber.
- Built executive dashboards (SQL, Tableau) for loan portfolios, cutting manual reporting effort by 40% and enabling real-time KPI tracking (default rates, approval ratio, NPL).
- Designed borrower segmentation models for a major bank, increasing approval precision by 12% and improving risk-adjusted portfolio profitability.

- Introduced a hypothesis-testing playbook that accelerated validation cycles by 25% and reduced failed product experiments.
- Built cost-efficiency models for a big-tech client, identifying \$2M+ in potential annual savings.

Data Analyst (Risk & Operations) | Aug 2019 – Oct 2023

Global data-protection, backup, and cybersecurity company — 1,800+ employees, 45+ offices worldwide.

- Analyzed and optimized global processes focused on risk-sensitive operations and approvals.
- Automated ETL pipelines and reporting scripts in Python, saving ~30% of manual effort and improving data quality.
- Introduced monitoring dashboards that reduced approval delays by 20% and increased operational transparency.

SIDE PROJECT

Founder & Solo Builder — AI Wellbeing & Brain-Fitness Telegram Bot

- Designed, built, and shipped an English-language Telegram bot combining Claude, GPT-4, and Gemini for playful psychological support — grew to 1,000+ users, deployed on a Dockerized server.
- Extended the product with AI-generated art therapy: images and color palettes mapped to a user's stated feelings to help with anxiety.
- Built and iterated entirely with AI coding tools (Claude Code, Cursor) — no traditional dev team, same operating model as an AI-native product org.

LANGUAGES

English — Advanced | Russian — Native | French — Basic

EDUCATION

- MIPT (Moscow Institute of Physics and Technology) — PhD Candidate, Computer Science, 2023 – Present
- MIPT — MSc, Applied Mathematics and Informatics, 2021 – 2023
- MIPT — BSc, Applied Mathematics and Informatics, 2017 – 2021

CERTIFICATES

- Applied Data Science with Python — Coursera, 2023
- Machine Learning — Stanford / Coursera, 2022
- SQL for Data Science — DataCamp, 2022
- Tableau Desktop Specialist, 2021
- A/B Testing for Business Analysts — Coursera, 2022